

Cimply Test Plan: Order Status Lifecycle

Writing sample — this test plan was authored directly from the Cimply PRD and API Reference, prior to implementation, to validate the Order Status business rules before development begins. Cimply is a demonstration product built to showcase documentation skills; it is not a live commercial product.

1. Objective

This plan defines the scope, approach, and success criteria for verifying that Cimply's Order Status lifecycle behaves according to the rules documented in the Cimply PRD and API Reference. It is written prior to implementation, so that engineering has an agreed, testable definition of "done" for the Change Order Status endpoint before development begins.

2. Scope

In Scope

- The Change Order Status endpoint (POST /orders/{order_id}/status) for all seven status types: new, assigned, in_progress, hold, submitted, complete, and cancelled.
- Role-based permission enforcement for status changes (Scheduler versus Designer).
- Prerequisite validation for the complete transition, including the required logged time entry.
- Terminal locking behavior once an Order reaches complete or cancelled.
- Default status assignment at Order creation (new versus assigned, based on whether a designer_id is supplied).

Out of Scope

- The Availability and Users resources.
- Webhook delivery and payload verification.
- Performance and load testing.
- P1 behavior allowing multiple Statuses per Type — not yet implemented in P0.
- User-interface-level testing; this plan covers API-level behavior only.

3. Test Approach

Testing is functional and performed at the API level, directly against the Change Order Status endpoint and its documented error contract (403 forbidden_status_transition, 409 invalid_status_transition, 409 time_entry_required). Test cases are derived from the PRD and API Reference rather than from existing code, since this plan predates implementation — validating the specification's completeness and giving engineering a shared, testable definition of the intended behavior. Each case will be executed manually once the endpoint reaches staging; cases confirmed stable across a release cycle are candidates for the automated regression suite.

4. Test Environment

A single staging account seeded with four users matching the roles in the User Guide: one Scheduler with the Admin flag, one Scheduler without it, and two Designers. Orders will be created through the API for each required precondition state (New, Assigned, In Progress, On Hold, Needs Review) rather than relying on production data, so that every test case starts from a known, reproducible state.

5. Entry Criteria

- The Orders section of the API Reference is finalized and unchanged since the last review.
- The staging environment is provisioned with the users described above.
- The Change Order Status endpoint is deployed to staging.

6. Exit Criteria

- All twelve cases in `Cimply_Test_Cases_Order_Status.xlsx` have been executed with a recorded pass or fail result.
- No High-priority defect remains open.
- Any deferred Medium-priority defect is logged with an owner and a target release.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

- Scheduler / Product Owner (Jynae): owns test case authorship and sign-off on exit criteria.
- QA: executes test cases and logs defects.
- Engineering: triages and resolves defects found during execution.

8. Risks and Assumptions

- Risk: P0 enforces exactly one Status per Type, so test cases reference status Types directly rather than account-specific Status names. If P1 ships mid-cycle, cases should be re-verified against accounts with multiple Statuses sharing a Type.
- Assumption: Terminal locking on complete and cancelled Orders is enforced at the API layer, not only in the UI — test cases target the API directly to confirm this rather than inferring it from dashboard behavior.
- Risk: Designer assignment email delivery is asynchronous (“within a few minutes” per the API Reference) and isn’t deterministically testable inline with a status-change request; it’s tracked as a lower-priority, separate verification rather than blocking exit criteria.

9. Related Artifacts

Detailed test cases, including preconditions, steps, and expected results for each scenario referenced above, are maintained separately in `Cimply_Test_Cases_Order_Status.xlsx`.